

EDUCATION IN THE PRELITERATE SOCIETY

CULTURAL TRANSMISSION: *before the invention of reading and writing the transmission was done orally.*

- **Trial and Error Learning** *enabled our ancestors to learn survival skills in an environment that pitted them against drought and floods, wild animals, attacks from hostile groups. Over time the survival skills became cultural patterns.*

- **Moral Codes** *— as groups developed survival skills, they passed these on to their children.*

They marked the passage from childhood to adulthood with ritual dancing, music and dramatic acting to create a powerful supernatural meaning and evoke a moral response.

Children learned the group's prescriptions (acceptable behavior) and the proscriptions or taboos (forbidden behavior).

Oral Tradition as a means to transmit cultural heritage — elders, priests, gifted storytellers sang or recited narratives of the group's past.

Combining myths and legends, the oral tradition told young people about the heroes, victories and defeats.

Songs and stories helped young people learn the spoken language and develop more abstract thinking about time and space.

STORYTELLING

remains a powerful tool, an engaging strategy in the classroom today. Through stories, learners meet their culture and its heroes, legends and past.

LITERACY — as toolmakers, they made and used spears, axes, arrows and other tools — the earliest examples of technology.

As language users, they created manipulative symbols in signs, pictographs, and letters, creating a written language was a great cultural leap to literacy and then to schooling.

To understand the worldwide movement to develop schools in literate society, a global reference has to be considered.

- Historical survey begins with China, India and Egypt.

KEY PERIODS IN EDUCATIONAL HISTORY:

1. Preliterate Societies:	7000 B.C. - 5000 B.C.
2. China:	3000 B.C. to A.D.1900
3. India:	3000 B.C. to the present
4. Egypt:	3000 B.C.to 300 B.C.
5. Greek:	1600 B.C. to 300 B.C.
6. Roman:	750 B.C.to A.D.450
7. Arabic:	A.D.700 to A.D. 1350
8. Medieval:	A.D. 500 to A.D. 1400
9. Renaissance:	A.D. 1350 to A.D. 1500
10. Reformation:	A.D.1500 to A.D. 1600

PRELITERATE SOCIETIES 7000 B.C. To 5000 B.C

Educational Goal	Instructional Methods
To teach group survival skills and group cohesiveness Students: children in the group	- Informal instruction; children imitating adult skills and values

Curriculum	Agents
- Survival skills of hunting, fishing, food gathering - stories, myths, songs, poems and dances	Parents, tribal elders and priests

INFLUENCES ON MODERN EDUCATION

EMPHASIS ON INFORMAL EDUCATION TO TRANSMIT SKILLS AND VALUES

CHINA 3000 B.C. To A.D. 1900

Educational Goal	Instructional Methods
To prepare elite officials to govern the empire according to Confucian principles Students: males of gentry class	- Memorization and recitation of classic texts

Curriculum	Agents
- Confucian classic	- Government officials

INFLUENCES ON MODERN EDUCATION

written examination for civil service and other professions

INDIA 3000 B.C. To present

Educational Goal	Instructional Methods
To learn behaviors and rituals based on the Vedas Students: males of upper castes	- Memorizing and interpreting sacred texts

Curriculum	Agents
- Vedas and religious texts	Brahmin priests-scholars

INFLUENCES ON MODERN EDUCATION

Cultural transmission and assimilation; spiritual detachment

EGYPT 3000 B.C. To 300 B.C.

Educational Goal	Instructional Methods
To prepare priests-scribes to administer the empire Students: males of upper classes	- Memorizing and copying dictated texts
Curriculum	Agents
- Religious or technical texts	Priests and scribes

INFLUENCES ON MODERN EDUCATION

Restrictions of educational controls and services to a priestly elite; use of education to prepare bureaucracy

GREEK 1600 B.C. To 300 B.C.

Educational Goal	Instructional Methods
ATHENS: to cultivate civic responsibility and identification with city-state and to develop well-rounded persons SPARTA: to train soldiers and military leaders Students: male children of citizens; ages 7-20	- Primary Schools: drill, memorization, recitation Higher Schools: lecture, discussion, dialogue

Curriculum	Agents
- ATHENS: reading, writing, arithmetic, drama, music, physical education, literature, poetry - SPARTA: drill, military songs and tactics	ATHENS: private teachers and schools, Sophists, philosophers SPARTA: military officers

INFLUENCES ON MODERN EDUCATION

ATHENS: the concept of well-rounded, liberally educated person

SPARTA: the concept of serving the military state

ROMAN 750 B.C. To A.D. 450

Educational Goal	Instructional Methods

To develop civic responsibility for republic then empire; to develop administrative and military skills Students: male children of citizens; ages 7-20	- Primary Schools: drill, memorization, recitation - Rhetorical Schools: declamation
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Curriculum	Agents
Reading, writing, arithmetic, Laws of Twelve Tables, Law, Philosophy	Private schools and teachers; schools of rhetoric

INFLUENCES ON MODERN EDUCATION

Emphasis on education for administrative skills; relating education to civic responsibility

ARABIC A.D. 700 To A.D. 1350

Educational Goal	Instructional Methods
To cultivate religious commitment to Islamic beliefs; to develop	- Lower Schools: drill, memorization, recitation

expertise in mathematics, medicine and science Students: male children of upper classes, ages 7-20	- Higher Schools: imitation and discussion
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Curriculum	Agents
- Reading, writing, mathematics, religious literature, scientific studies	Mosques, court schools

INFLUENCES ON MODERN EDUCATION

Arabic numerals and computation; reentry of classical materials on science and medicine

MEDIEVAL A.D. 500 To A.D. 1400

Educational Goal	Instructional Methods
To develop religious commitment, knowledge and ritual; to prepare persons for appropriate role in a hierarchical society	- Lower Schools: Drill, memorization, recitation, chanting

Students: children of upper classes or those entering religious life, ages 7-20	- -Higher Schools and Universities: textual analysis and disputation - Higher Schools: imitation and discussion
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Curriculum	Agents
- Reading, writing, arithmetic, liberal arts; philosophy, theology; crafts; military tactics and chivalry	Parish, chantry and cathedral schools; universities, apprenticeship, knighthood

INFLUENCES ON MODERN EDUCATION

Established structure, content and organization of universities as major institutions of higher education; the institutionalization and preservation of knowledge

RENAISSANCE A.D. 1350 To A.D. 1500

Educational Goal	Instructional Methods
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To cultivate humanist experts in the classics (Greek and Latin); to prepare courtiers for service to dynamic leaders Students: male children of aristocracy and upper classes, ages 7-20	- Memorization, translation and analysis of Greek and Roman classics
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Curriculum	Agents
- Latin, Greek, classical literature, poetry, arts	Classical humanist educators and schools such as the <i>lycee</i>, <i>gymnasium</i>, and Latin schools

INFLUENCES ON MODERN EDUCATION

Emphasis on literary knowledge, excellence and style as expressed in classical literature; a two-track system of schools

REFORMATION A.D. 1500 To A.D. 1600

Educational Goal	Instructional Methods

To instill commitment to a particular religious denomination; to cultivate general literacy Students: boys and girls ages 7-12 in vernacular schools; young men ages 7-12 of upper class backgrounds in humanist schools	- Memorization, drill, indoctrination, catechetical instruction in vernacular schools; - translation and analysis of classical literature in humanist schools
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Curriculum	Agents
- Reading, writing, arithmetic, catechism, religious concepts and ritual; Latin and Greek; theology	Vernacular elementary schools for the masses; classical schools for the upper class

INFLUENCES ON MODERN EDUCATION

A commitment to universal education to provide literacy to the masses; the origin of school systems with supervision to ensure doctrinal conformity; the dual-track school system based on socioeconomic class and career goals

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